



REACH ASSESSMENTS™

PAPER

A

English

2019

**DO NOT OPEN THIS BOOKLET
UNTIL INSTRUCTED.**

35 QUESTIONS

TIME ALLOWED: 45 MINUTES

Read the instructions on the **ANSWER SHEET** and fill in your **NAME, SCHOOL** and **OTHER INFORMATION**.

Use a pencil. Do **NOT** use a coloured pencil or a pen.

Rub out any mistakes completely.

You **MUST** record your answers on the **ANSWER SHEET**.

Mark only **ONE** answer for each question.

Your score will be the number of correct answers.

Marks are **NOT** deducted for incorrect answers.

There are **35 MULTIPLE-CHOICE QUESTIONS** (1–35).

Use the information provided to choose the **BEST** answer from the four possible options.

On your **ANSWER SHEET** fill in the oval that matches your answer.

Questions may sometimes be placed next to each other.

Make sure you read **ACROSS** the page and answer the questions in the correct order.

You are **NOT** allowed to use a dictionary or an electronic translator.

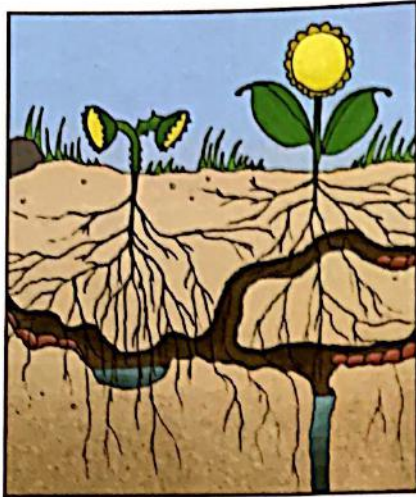


UNSW Global

Earthworms eat dirt!

Earthworms help to make soil healthy.

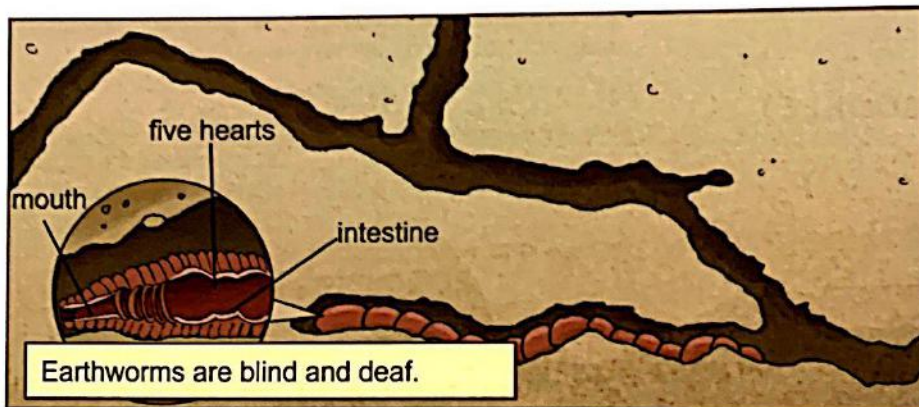
Earthworms dig long burrows in soil. They do this by eating soil and plant matter.



Earthworm burrows help plants and animals. Plant roots grow easily along the burrows and water can move along them to the plant roots. The burrows also create air spaces that help other animals to survive.

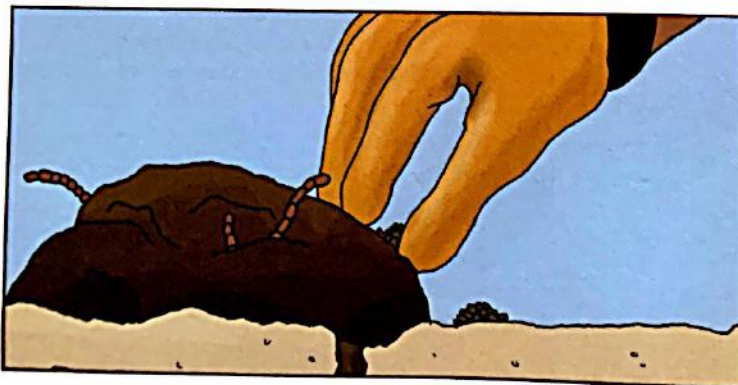


Earthworms breathe through their skin. Too much water in the soil means they can't breathe. They come out of their burrows in heavy rain so they don't drown. Some birds have learned to tap on the ground so earthworms think it is raining.



Earthworms are blind and deaf.

The soil passes through the earthworm's body and comes out as castings (worm poo). The castings help to add nutrients to the soil.



Some people collect the castings to put on their gardens.

1. The word 'create', as it is used in the text, means

- (A) follow.
- (B) begin.
- (C) draw.
- (D) make.

2. Birds want earthworms to think it is raining so that

- (A) the earthworms will not drown.
- (B) the earthworms will not dig deeper.
- (C) the earthworms will come to the surface.
- (D) the earthworms will make more castings.

3. The purpose of this view of the worm is to show



- (A) a part of a worm in more detail.
- (B) a close-up of a worm burrow.
- (C) a detailed view of a casting.
- (D) a close-up view of a worm's skin.

4. How do earthworms make soil healthier?

- (A) by attracting birds
- (B) by adding nutrients
- (C) by eating plants
- (D) by releasing water

5. In the diagram, the person is

- (A) collecting castings.
- (B) collecting earthworms.
- (C) digging in the soil.
- (D) planting flowers.

6. This text is mainly about

- (A) how birds trick earthworms.
- (B) which animals live in soil.
- (C) how earthworms help to improve soil.
- (D) why plants are important to earthworms.

LOLA

I usually love waking up on a Saturday morning. On a school day it seems to take forever to find my uniform, get washed, dressed and downstairs for breakfast. But on Saturdays I can get from my bed to my breakfast in exactly fifty-three seconds! I know I can do it because I've timed it.

But today I feel a bit weird. It's like I'm in slow motion and my head feels too heavy to lift off the pillow. I can hear Mum downstairs and she sounds so cheery, like she's been up for hours. When I look at my clock, I realise why. It's 9 o'clock! She has been up for hours. I've wasted half of Saturday!

There is a plan for today, I'm sure. It starts with soccer. Then home for lunch before Tommy's party. I've been looking forward to it for ages. Mum has bought Tommy the best present ever. It's a science kit that shows you how to make a real rocket. He's going to love it and I know he'll ask me to help him build it. Yet, I can't seem to get out of bed.

The phone rings downstairs. I'd usually run and answer it but I feel exhausted even thinking about standing up. When Mum taps on my door a minute later, it's with bad news. Tommy's party is cancelled.

Sitting on my bed, she feels my head and then unbuttons my pyjama top to look at my super-spotty tummy. Tommy has chickenpox. And so do I!



7. Which quotation from the first paragraph tells readers that something different is going to happen to Lola?
- (A) 'I usually love waking up on a Saturday morning.'
 - (B) 'On a school day it seems to take forever to find my uniform'
 - (C) 'I can get from my bed to my breakfast in exactly fifty-three seconds!'
 - (D) 'I know I can do it'
8. Why did Lola say that she had 'wasted half of Saturday'?
- (A) She was feeling unwell.
 - (B) Her mother had forgotten to wake her up.
 - (C) She had slept in later than usual.
 - (D) Her alarm clock had not rung.
9. What do the words 'looking forward to' mean?
- (A) planning for
 - (B) ready for
 - (C) promising to go to
 - (D) excited about
10. 'Mum has bought Tommy the best present ever.'
- What is the effect of the word 'ever'?
- (A) It simplifies what happened.
 - (B) It exaggerates the statement.
 - (C) It shows Lola's determination.
 - (D) It shows that the information is important.
11. Which quotation is about something that happened in Lola's past?
- (A) 'I've timed it'
 - (B) 'It's a science kit'
 - (C) 'Yet, I can't seem to get out of bed.'
 - (D) 'The phone rings downstairs.'
12. Why was Tommy's party cancelled?
- (A) He woke up late.
 - (B) Lola could not go to the party.
 - (C) Lola had chickenpox.
 - (D) He had chickenpox.
13. What is Lola most likely to do next?
- (A) She will run down for breakfast.
 - (B) She will make the rocket.
 - (C) She will go to soccer.
 - (D) She will rest.

The Triantiwontigongolope

5 There's a very funny insect that you do not often spy,
And it isn't quite a spider, and it isn't quite a fly;
It is something like a beetle, and a little like a bee,
But nothing like a woolly grub that climbs upon a tree.
Its name is quite a hard one, but you'll learn it soon, I hope.
So, try:

Tri-

Tri-anti-wonti

Triantiwontigongolope.

10 It lives on weeds and wattle-gum, and has a funny face;
Its appetite is hearty, and its manners a disgrace.
When first you come upon it, it will give you quite a scare,
But when you look for it again you find it isn't there.
And unless you call it softly it will stay away and mope.

15 So, try:

Tri-

Tri-anti-wonti

Triantiwontigongolope.

20 It trembles if you tickle it or tread upon its toes;
It is not an early riser, but it has a snubbish nose.
If you sneer at it or scold it, it will scuttle off in shame,
But it purrs and purrs quite proudly if you call it by its name,
And offer it some sandwiches of sealing-wax and soap.
So, try:

25 Tri-

Tri-anti-wonti

Triantiwontigongolope.

30 But of course you haven't seen it; and I truthfully confess
That I haven't seen it either, and I don't know its address.
For there isn't such an insect, though there really might have been
If the trees and grass were purple, and the sky was bottle-green.
It's just a little joke of mine, which you'll forgive, I hope.
Oh, try:

Try!

35 Tri-anti-wonti

Triantiwontigongolope.

C.J. Dennis

14. The purpose of the first three stanzas is
- (A) to explain how the creature is similar to other insects.
 - (B) to describe the creature for those who have not seen it.
 - (C) to warn readers to be careful of the creature.
 - (D) to outline the best way to track down the creature.
15. In line 14 the word 'mope' means
- (A) sulk.
 - (B) shiver.
 - (C) sleep.
 - (D) disappear.
16. The poet says that the creature makes a _____ sound.
- (A) buzzing
 - (B) scratching
 - (C) purring
 - (D) chomping
17. 'If the trees and grass were purple, and the sky was bottle-green' (line 31)
Why is this line included in the poem?
- (A) to indicate the type of environment the creature prefers
 - (B) to point out the place where the creature hides
 - (C) to describe a time when the creature was alive
 - (D) to show that the creature is imaginary
18. At the end of the poem, the poet apologises for
- (A) not using an easier name for the creature.
 - (B) trying to trick the reader into believing that the creature exists.
 - (C) not being able to describe the creature more accurately.
 - (D) asking the reader to search for the creature.
19. 'So, try:
Tri-
Tri-anti-wonti
Triantiwontigongolope.'

The last four lines of each stanza are set out in this way because

- (A) it helps the reader say the creature's name.
- (B) the creature's name is too long to fit on one line.
- (C) it separates the three words that make up the creature's name.
- (D) the creature's name is also the title of the poem.

Pencil **POWER**

The birth of the pencil

The story of pencils began in England more than 500 years ago. Legend says that a tree fell over in a sheep paddock in a part of England called Borrowdale. Curious shepherds found lumps of heavy, greasy, black rock lying among the tangled roots. This mysterious rock left black stuff on the shepherds' hands when they touched it. They soon found a use for it. The dirty black rock was perfect for marking their sheep.

The shepherds also found a way to stop it getting on their hands. They wrapped slabs of the black rock in sheepskin. The first pencils were born!

A name change

The shepherds who used the greasy, black rock called it lead because it reminded them of the metal called lead: it was about the same colour and it felt heavy. It wasn't lead, though. It wasn't even a metal. It was a rock. A German geologist (a scientist who studies rocks) called Abraham Gottlob Werner gave it a new name: *graphite*. He called it that because the ancient Greek word *graphein* means 'mark' or 'write'. So the black rod in the centre of your pencil that everyone calls 'lead' is not lead at all: it's graphite.

The magic of clay

Lumps of pure graphite like the ones the shepherds found are very rare. Therefore, to make pencils these days, rocks containing small amounts of graphite are crushed and the graphite is extracted (taken out). The graphite is then mixed with clay and made into rods. The graphite and clay rods are cooked until they're hard and dry. They are then encased in wood.

	9B		F
	7B		H
	4B		2H
	2B		4H
	B		7H
	HB		9H

B pencils have more graphite in them;
H pencils have more clay.
F pencils have fine points.
Here you can see the sort of marks they make.



20. The words 'Legend says' are used to introduce the story of the shepherds because they indicate that
- (A) only people in ancient times believed the story.
 - (B) the story should not be considered as historical fact.
 - (C) scientists are still trying to prove that the story is not true.
 - (D) the story is believed by the people who live in Borrowdale.
21. Under the subheading 'A name change', the information in brackets () is provided to explain
- (A) what type of work a geologist does.
 - (B) how a geologist discovered graphite.
 - (C) why Abraham Werner was a famous geologist.
 - (D) how a geologist worked out that graphite was a rock.
22. According to the text, pure graphite is **NOT** used to make pencils because it is
- (A) too soft.
 - (B) too messy.
 - (C) hard to find.
 - (D) difficult to crush.
23. Subheadings are used in this text in order to
- (A) make the text more complete.
 - (B) stress that the information is accurate.
 - (C) help younger children decide what to read.
 - (D) indicate the type of information found in each section.
24. 'B pencils have more graphite in them;
H pencils have more clay.'
- What is the best way to combine the two parts of this sentence without changing its meaning?
- (A) B pencils have more graphite in them since H pencils have more clay.
 - (B) B pencils have more graphite in them whereas H pencils have more clay.
 - (C) B pencils have more graphite in them because H pencils have more clay.
 - (D) B pencils have more graphite in them although H pencils have more clay.
25. The purpose of this text is to
- (A) tell a story about the importance of pencils.
 - (B) provide information about the history of pencils.
 - (C) instruct readers on how to make a pencil at home.
 - (D) explain the importance of geologists in the discovery of pencils.

Make a wish

Carl sat chewing, his glasses balanced on the very tip of his nose. He was concentrating very hard. Cass watched fascinated. One more chew and they would slip off. 'Well,' Carl lifted his head and his glasses slid back into place, 'I don't know if we can do anything more, Cass. If adults can't stop them, what can we do?'

The twins ate in silence, watching the sun slip behind the distant skyline, silhouetting the tall faceless office blocks that poked out of a shifting yellow haze. The din of the city traffic barely reached them. It mingled with the warm shushing sound of the surrounding park.

The Trumper Tree rose above them, majestic and tall, its twisted branches and gnarled trunk swirling in strange patterns. It looked as if it reached into the sky forever.

'I'm going to save a leaf from the Trumper Tree as a memento,' said Cass and she picked up a fallen leaf. 'Here's one for you,' and she handed it to Carl. He was very quiet. The air became heavy and still. The park seemed to be holding its breath. 'Let's make a wish, a wish to make things right,' whispered Cass.

'I don't believe in wishes,' was Carl's reply, but he didn't push the leaf away; he placed it carefully in his pocket.

Around them the valley waited, motionless and silent. Cass shivered. 'I feel strange, eerie. I can almost hear the tree speaking to me.'

'What am I supposed to listen for?'

'Quiet! Can't you hear? There's a sound in the leaves, a sort of stirring, a movement, a rustling.'

'And for your next trick there'll be gnomes in the grass.' Carl was not impressed.

Cass was listening intently. 'It's saying that now is the time, now is special, if we wish now something important will happen.'

'And pigs might fly. Come on Cass, it's time we went home.'

'Please let's try one wish now. Come on Carl, please ...!'

'Oh, all right. Just one, then we must go or Mum and Dad will be late for that meeting.'

'Let's put our arms around the tree and wish hard for something to save it.'

26. What was Carl doing in the first paragraph?
- (A) arguing with his sister
 - (B) hiding from his parents
 - (C) quickly finishing a big meal
 - (D) thinking deeply about a problem
27. In the second paragraph, the words 'silhouetting the tall faceless office blocks' refer to the effect of the
- (A) sun.
 - (B) tree.
 - (C) haze.
 - (D) skyline.
28. Personification is a type of description that gives human qualities to something which is not human.
- Which quotation uses personification?
- (A) 'The twins ate in silence'
 - (B) 'The park seemed to be holding its breath.'
 - (C) 'There's a sound in the leaves'
 - (D) 'And pigs might fly.'
29. In the third paragraph, why does the writer describe the Trumper Tree as having a 'gnarled trunk swirling in strange patterns'?
- (A) to emphasise how bright the sun is
 - (B) to create a mysterious atmosphere
 - (C) to make a comparison with city buildings
 - (D) to highlight the colour of its leaves and branches
30. A 'memento' is something that a person keeps from an event or a thing in order to
- (A) honour it.
 - (B) remember it.
 - (C) protect it.
 - (D) keep it alive.
31. Which quotation shows that Carl would follow Cass and make a wish?
- (A) 'He was very quiet.'
 - (B) 'What am I supposed to listen for?'
 - (C) 'Come on Cass, it's time we went home.'
 - (D) 'Just one, then we must go'
32. The last four sections of the text are shorter paragraphs because
- (A) the layout of the text needs to be clear.
 - (B) new topics are being introduced.
 - (C) the content of the text is simple.
 - (D) there is a conversation taking place.

The Night Noodle Market

I was slightly puzzled when Mum mentioned that she wanted to take us to the Night Noodle Market in the city. I knew what noodles were but what were 'night noodles', I wondered. Did they glow in the dark? Were they only able to be eaten' (33) the evening?

'It's like a picnic at night,' Mum explained. 'There are stalls selling noodles (34) other kinds of Asian-style food.' I was convinced! My younger brother needed some help (35) the idea though ...

'Mum?'

'Yes, Thomas.'

'Will the night noodles be scary? I think I only like day noodles.'

33. Choose the option that best completes the text.

- (A) by
- (B) on
- (C) from
- (D) in

34. Choose the option that best completes the text.

- (A) caused by
- (B) resulting in
- (C) as well as
- (D) because of

35. Choose the option that best completes the text.

- (A) to
- (B) with
- (C) beside
- (D) over

